MESSAGE DRIFT

Prototype and User Testing

TUT09 Group1

Yiyang Li yili0658

Lian Gao lgao0790

Puttimeth Treetanajitt ptre0887

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Zilong Zhu zzhu0898

IDEA9106 Design Thinking
Week 9 Tutorial: Usability testing hypothesis and plan outline
(also on Week 9 Figma board)

Testing hypothesis
If we make a **[Drifted Message, an interactive piece of art(bottle) on the wall with an anonymous message system]**
We expect to help **[international students]** and local students to connect and **[reduce the disconnectivity]** on the campus
By **[providing a chance for them to meet up with the people who shared the same interests and ice breaking each other from sharing their thoughts].**

Testing plan outline

- Name of the prototype being testing

=Message Drift

- Description of the prototype being testing eg., mobile, freestanding kiosk, VR game etc

= It is a mixed testing between offline and online prototypes. A lo-fi physical bottle with a number labeled on it taped on the cardboard kiosk wall with a mobile prototype screen lying beside the bottle, and a cut-out circle token. A cutout paper will be taped on the wall between 2 bottles in the middle to show a line/dot to connect the two bottles together when the system pairs them together. Behind the bottle is a tiny hole cutout so that a flashlight can be shone to imitate that the bottle itself is interactive and can light up or change color based on the prototype system that detects the mood of the user's message. The user will first interact with the mobile prototype, then the physical object(bottle) will simulate the process of the interaction by being lit up, and then the user will use the cutout token to tap on the prototype screen to continue with the process. A line/dot will be physically shown to simulate how the linking of bottles works.

- Testing goal/s:

= Able to fulfil the objective of the project, it should be clear and successfully guide the tester to help them complete the interaction, and be able to receive benefits afterward.

1. To test whether users understand how to leave a short anonymous message.
2. To test whether users understand that their message will become part of the wall, a glowing bottle on the wall creates a piece of art.
3. To test whether the user understands how to see or respond to another student's bottle.

4. To test whether users understand the meaning of each color represented on the bottle, the use of the token, and the visual graphics.
5. To test whether the interaction feels low-pressure, comfortable, and emotionally supportive.

· Logistics eg. time, dates, location and format of study etc

Date: Week 10 tutorial, 5/5/2026
Time: 13:00-15:00
Location: H70.03.3190. Belinda Hutchinson Building Studio
Format: In-person usability testing, one participant at a time
Session length: Around 8–10 minutes per participant

· Participant profile/s

University students, especially students who use campus spaces.

· Testing method/s

The main testing method will be Think Aloud protocol. Participants will be asked to say what they are thinking while completing each task.

· Testing tasks

1. Able to leave an anonymous message
2. Drift your message into the sea of thoughts
3. Use of the token
4. Connect with another bottle
5. Notify the person who has the token
6. Provide a time slot for connecting with each other

Recommended

· Script for the testing protocol (minimum components)

Introduction, including seeking consent:

Hi, thank you for participating in our usability test. We are testing a lo-fi prototype called Message Drift. It is an interactive public art installation that allows students to leave, discover, respond, and connect with other students through short anonymous messages.

This is not a test of you. We are testing the design. If something is confusing, it is helpful for us to know. Please think aloud while completing the tasks, which means saying what you are thinking, what you expect to happen, and anything you find confusing.

This session will be video recorded for assessment and analysis purposes. Your responses will only be used for this project. You can stop at any time. Do you consent to participate and be recorded? Please write your name and sign the consent paper for us.

Explanation for Task 1: (You are walking past the Message Drift wall and want to leave a short anonymous feeling or thought. Please use the prototype to leave one message)

Explanation for Task 2:(Throw your bottle from the screen to the wall)

Explanation for Task 3:(Takes the bottle token and taps on the screen, keep your thought with you (magsafe))

Explanation for Task 4:(The system has now found another anonymous bottle that shares similar thoughts/mood/traits with you. Do you want to know them/meet them? Please choose drift in closer so that the system will bring both of you closer)

Explanation for Task 5:(Now that you are interested in meeting the person, you can notify them by sending a quiet hello.)

Explanation for Task 6:(Now you can choose a time slot or leave a message for them. The system will automatically send the signal of your message and let the person with the token know by alerting them with light/vibration on their token to remind them that someone has responded to their message and interest to them and must return to the location)

Post-test instructions/questions:

Questions:
1. Do you feel that you can connect with other students better after this interaction?
2. Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?
3. What part of the interaction was easiest to understand? What part do you think needs refinement?
4. Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?
5. Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

Individual Testing Section

Name: Yiyang Li

Unikey: yili0658

Participant Number: 1

Prototype Name: Message Drift

Participant Testing Summary:

The participant completed the core interaction of leaving an anonymous message and understood that the message became part of the wall as a coloured bottle. They responded positively to the anonymous and low-pressure nature of the experience, saying that it could help them share thoughts and relieve stress. However, they were less interested in continuing into the social matching or meeting pathway. Instead, they preferred to leave only their message on the wall and cancel the match. This suggests that the prototype already supports different levels of participation, but the “leave message only” option needs to be made clearer in the interface, so users understand that they can simply contribute a coloured bottle without continuing to connect with others.

Consent Form:

Usability Testing

Data sheet (3)

Consent Form

I agree to participate in the study conducted and recorded by Yiyang Li

I agree to:

☑ The session being audio/video-recorded (cross out as appropriate)

☐ The use of photographs and video recordings for the purpose of documenting the findings from this study

I understand that the information collected in this study is for research purposes only and that my name and image will not be used for any other purpose. I relinquish any rights to the recording.

I understand that participation in this usability study is voluntary, and I agree to immediately raise any concerns or areas of discomfort during the session with the study administrator.

I confirm that I have read and understand the information on this form and that any questions I might have about the session have been answered.

Date: 2023. 6. 6

Please print your name: Zichen Zeng

Please sign your name: 曾子辰

Thank you! We appreciate your participation.

Task completion sheet

Usability Testing

Data sheet (1)

Notetaker: Yiyang Li

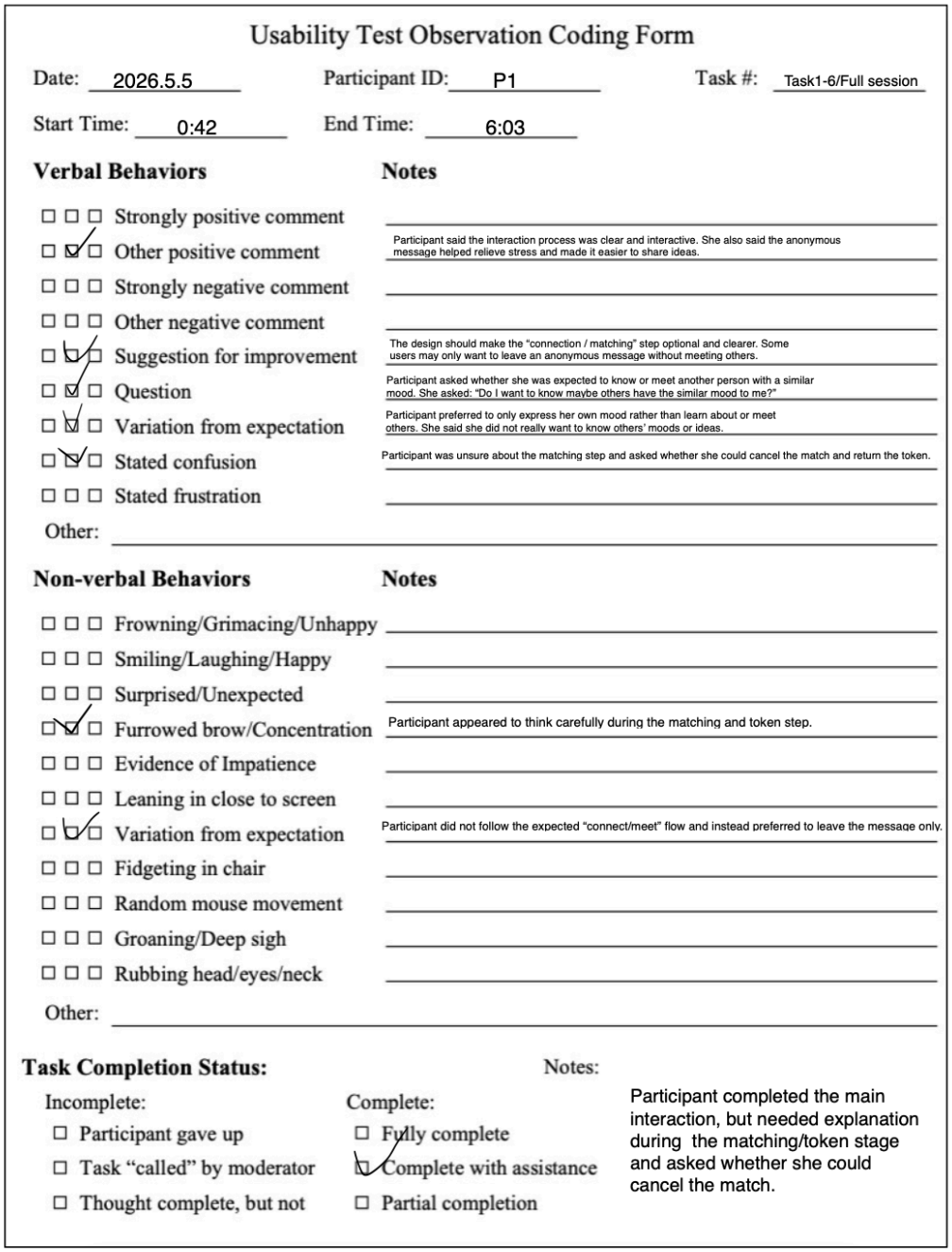
Participant #: 1

Tested product *(e.g. website URL)*: Message Drift

Task(s) (Enter a brief description for each task)	Success (0 = Not completed, 1 = Completed with difficulty or help, 2 = Easily completed)	Time to complete	# of Errors	Notes/Observations (Note why the user was successful or not successful, e.g. wrong pathways, confusing page layout, navigation issues, terminology)
#1: Leave an anonymous message	2	1 min	0	Participant was able to leave a short anonymous message through the phone prototype. She understand type a mood or thought.
#2: Drift the message from the screen to the wall	2	30 sec	0	Participant understood message became a coloured on the wall. The yellow colour was representing her mood.
#3: Take and use the bottle token	1	1min	1	Participant needed explanation about the token and matching step. She later asked whether she could return the token, which needs more clear explanations.
#4: Connect with another bottle	1	1-2min	1	Participant understood that another bottle had a similar mood, but she did not personally want to know or meet that person. She prefer leave own message
#5: Send quiet hello and choose time slot / leave message	1	1min	1	Participant understood that she could cancel the connection and leave the message only. Timeslot and meet-up function may feel unnessary for users.

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Observation notes / Observation Summary



Usability Test Observation Coding Form

Date: 2026.5.5 Participant ID: P1 Task #: Task1-6/Full session

Start Time: 0:42 End Time: 6:03

Verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly positive comment	
☐ ☑ ☐ Other positive comment	Participant said the interaction process was clear and interactive. She also said the anonymous message helped relieve stress and made it easier to share ideas.
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly negative comment	
☐ ☐ ☐ Other negative comment	
☐ ☑ ☐ Suggestion for improvement	The design should make the "connection / matching" step optional and clearer. Some users may only want to leave an anonymous message without meeting others.
☐ ☑ ☐ Question	Participant asked whether she was expected to know or meet another person with a similar mood. She asked: "Do I want to know maybe others have the similar mood to me?"
☐ ☑ ☐ Variation from expectation	Participant preferred to only express her own mood rather than learn about or meet others. She said she did not really want to know others' moods or ideas.
☐ ☑ ☐ Stated confusion	Participant was unsure about the matching step and asked whether she could cancel the match and return the token.
☐ ☐ ☐ Stated frustration	
Other:	

Non-verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Frowning/Grimacing/Unhappy	
☐ ☐ ☐ Smiling/Laughing/Happy	
☐ ☐ ☐ Surprised/Unexpected	
☐ ☑ ☐ Furrowed brow/Concentration	Participant appeared to think carefully during the matching and token step.
☐ ☐ ☐ Evidence of Impatience	
☐ ☐ ☐ Leaning in close to screen	
☐ ☑ ☐ Variation from expectation	Participant did not follow the expected "connect/meet" flow and instead preferred to leave the message only.
☐ ☐ ☐ Fidgeting in chair	
☐ ☐ ☐ Random mouse movement	
☐ ☐ ☐ Groaning/Deep sigh	
☐ ☐ ☐ Rubbing head/eyes/neck	
Other:	

Task Completion Status:

Incomplete:
- ☐ Participant gave up
- ☐ Task "called" by moderator
- ☐ Thought complete, but not

Complete:
- ☐ Fully complete
- ☑ Complete with assistance
- ☐ Partial completion

Notes:

Participant completed the main interaction, but needed explanation during the matching/token stage and asked whether she could cancel the match.

Post-test interview answers / key transcript

Q1. Do you feel that you can connect with other students better after this interaction?

Partly. The participant felt the platform could help express private moods or thoughts. However, they did not always want to know or meet others. This suggests the concept should support both “leave only” and “connect” pathways.

Q2. Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?

Mostly yes. The participant understood the general idea of leaving a message and seeing emotion represented visually. However, the matching / knowing others function felt less necessary for them personally.

Q3. What part was easiest to understand? What needs refinement?

The anonymous message and mood-sharing part was easiest to understand. The matching, token-return, and meet/know others steps need clearer explanation and should remain optional.

Q4. Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?

Yes. The participant said the anonymous message could relieve stress and make it easier to share ideas.

Q5. Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

Yes, I think it’s helpful for me.

Key Findings and Design Implications

Finding 1: Anonymous message is the strongest part of the concept.
Evidence: The participant said anonymous sharing could relieve stress and make it easier to express ideas.
Design implication: Keep anonymous message leaving as the main entry point.

Finding 2: Not every user wants to connect or meet.
Evidence: The participant said they often only want to express their own mood, not necessarily know others’ moods.
Design implication: Add a clear “leave only” pathway. Do not force matching, meeting, or token use.

Finding 3: Matching needs clearer and softer wording.

Evidence: The participant asked whether they could cancel the match, showing uncertainty about what matching means.
Design implication: Replace “match” with softer language such as “similar feeling” or “related bottle”.

Finding 4: Token should be optional and easier to understand.
Evidence: The participant asked whether they could return the token.
Design implication: Make token use optional and explain it as a reminder only, not a contact or commitment tool.

Other Group Testing Participation

Tutorial number:09
Group name: 02
Prototype name: Step by Step
My role: Participant
Date: 05/05/2026

AI Appendix

I used ChatGPT to help organise my user testing data, refine the wording of my transcript and interview notes. The final design direction, interpretation of the testing results, and decisions about what to include in the submission were reviewed, selected, and edited by me.

Other Materials

Usability Testing

Data sheet (2)

System Usability Scale

Participant #__1__

		strongly disagree 1	2	3	4	strongly agree 5
1	I think that I would like to use this system frequently.			✓		
2	I found the system unnecessarily complex.			✓		
3	I thought the system was easy to use.				✓	
4	I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.			✓		
5	I found the various functions in this system were well-integrated.			✓		
6	I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.					
7	I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.		✓			
8	I found the system very cumbersome to use.			✓		
9	I felt very confident using the system.				✓	
10	I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system.		✓			

Source: Brooke, J. (1996). SUS-A quick and dirty usability scale. In P.W. Jordan, B. Thomas, I.L. McClelland and B. Weerdmeester (Eds.) Usability evaluation in industry, pp.189-194. London: Taylor and Francis.

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designthinkmakebreakrepeat.com

Please assess the product now by ticking one circle per line.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7		
annoying	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	enjoyable	1
not understandable	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	understandable	2
creative	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	dull	3
easy to learn	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	difficult to learn	4
valuable	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	inferior	5
boring	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	exciting	6
not interesting	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	interesting	7
unpredictable	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	predictable	8
fast	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	slow	9
inventive	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	conventional	10
obstructive	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	supportive	11
good	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	bad	12
complicated	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	easy	13
unlikable	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	pleasing	14
usual	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	leading edge	15
unpleasant	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	pleasant	16
secure	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	not secure	17
motivating	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	demotivating	18
meets expectations	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	does not meet expectations	19
inefficient	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	efficient	20
clear	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	confusing	21
impractical	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	practical	22
organized	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	cluttered	23
attractive	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	unattractive	24
friendly	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	unfriendly	25
conservative	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	innovative	26

Individual Testing Section

Name: Lian Gao

Unikey: lgao0790

Participant Number: 2

Prototype Name: Message Drift

Participant Testing Summary:

The participant completely experienced all the process of the prototype Message Drift with assistance. From leaving a message on the screen to trying the token's function, he can understand the aim and usage of installation fast. However, it's not very successful for him to try to use the token. He looks confused to follow installatioeasierhe screen. From the Q&A after the testing, he suggested the whole experience is good and meaningful, but the steps to use token are quite complicated. It would be better to give more instructions on the screen or simplify the steps.

Consent Form:

Usability Testing

Data sheet (3)

Consent Form

I agree to participate in the study conducted and recorded by LIAN GAO (TUT09. Group 1. MessageDiff)

I agree to:

☑ The session being audio/video-recorded (cross out as appropriate)

☑ The use of photographs and video recordings for the purpose of documenting the findings from this study

I understand that the information collected in this study is for research purposes only and that my name and image will not be used for any other purpose. I relinquish any rights to the recording.

I understand that participation in this usability study is voluntary, and I agree to immediately raise any concerns or areas of discomfort during the session with the study administrator.

I confirm that I have read and understand the information on this form and that any questions I might have about the session have been answered.

Date: 5th. May. 2025.

Please print your name: Ruidong Xu

Please sign your name: Ruidong Xu

Thank you! We appreciate your participation.

Task completion sheet

Usability Testing

Data sheet (1)

Notetaker LIAN GAO

Participant # Ruiday Xu #2

Tested product *(e.g. website URL)*: Message Drift

Task(s) (Enter a brief description for each task)	Success 0 = Not completed 1 = Completed with difficulty or help 2 = Easily completed	Time to complete	# of Errors	Notes/Observations (Note why the user was successful or not successful, e.g. wrong pathways, confusing page layout, navigation issues, terminology)
#1: Able to leave an anonymous message.	2	1 min		Instructions are clear on the screen
#2: Drift your message into the 'Sea'	2	30s		Animation leading to the goal
#3: Use token	1	1 min		Steps are too many to understand.
#4: Connect with another bottle	2	30s		Intuitive.
#5: Notify the person who has token	0	\		~~Good task.~~ Hard to simulate with just 1 tester.

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Observation notes / Observation Summary

Usability Test Observation Coding Form

Date: 5/5/2026 Participant ID: Ruidong Xu #2 Task #: 1~5

Start Time: _____ End Time: _____

Verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly positive comment	
☐ ☑ ☐ Other positive comment	common positive (normal), experience is good
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly negative comment	
☐ ☐ ☐ Other negative comment	
☐ ☐ ☑ Suggestion for improvement	Process are little bit complicated.
☐ ☐ ☐ Question	
☐ ☐ ☐ Variation from expectation	
☐ ☑ ☐ Stated confusion	How to use token.
☐ ☐ ☐ Stated frustration	
Other:	

Non-verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Frowning/Grimacing/Unhappy	
☐ ☐ ☐ Smiling/Laughing/Happy	
☐ ☐ ☐ Surprised/Unexpected	
☐ ☐ ☐ Furrowed brow/Concentration	
☐ ☑ ☐ Evidence of Impatience	feel confused while using token.
☐ ☐ ☑ Leaning in close to screen	To see screen clearly
☐ ☐ ☐ Variation from expectation	
☐ ☐ ☐ Fidgeting in chair	
☐ ☐ ☐ Random mouse movement	
☐ ☐ ☐ Groaning/Deep sigh	
☐ ☐ ☐ Rubbing head/eyes/neck	
Other:	

Task Completion Status:

Notes: with assistance, complete successfully

Incomplete:	Complete:
☐ Participant gave up	☐ Fully complete
☐ Task "called" by moderator	☑ Complete with assistance
☐ Thought complete, but not	☐ Partial completion

Source: https://www.uslegalforms.com/form-library/527894-usability-test-observation-coding-form

Post-test interview answers / key transcript

Q1. Do you feel that you can connect with other students after the interaction? Maybe, yeah can, maybe some.

Q2: Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?

I think the process of using the token is not very clear.

Q3. What part was easiest to understand? What needs refinement?

There might be some notice on the screen to let you take the token and take it. You may refine the token process to make it easier to use.

Q4. Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?

Yeah, it's low-pressure. The experience is good.

Q5. Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

No it's hard to say, sometimes I may feel more pressured.

Key Findings and Design Implications

Finding1: The theme of Message Drift is meaningful and easy to understand.

Evidence: From Q&A and other conversations the participant showed his preference to the prototype. And he is willing to try those functions.

Finding2: The basic experience of installation is good.

Evidence: The participant has mentioned this point in Q&A.

Finding3: The steps of using the tokens could be refined, now it's complicated and lack of instructions.

Evidence: The participant has also mentioned this point in Q&A. In addition, he showed confusion in the testing which was noted from observing.

Other Group Testing Participation

Tutorial number:09
Group name: 03
Prototype name: Echoing insight
My role: Participant
Date: 05/05/2026

AI Appendix

I used notta AI to transcribe the audio from the video file. And ChatGpt is used for refining the written expression in some parts of this assignment.

Other Materials

Usability Testing

Data sheet (2)

System Usability Scale

Participant # Ruidong Xu #2

		strongly disagree 1	2	3	4	strongly agree 5
1	I think that I would like to use this system frequently.					✓
2	I found the system unnecessarily complex.	✓				
3	I thought the system was easy to use.			✓		
4	I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.		✓			
5	I found the various functions in this system were well-integrated.					✓
6	I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.		✓			
7	I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.				✓	
8	I found the system very cumbersome to use.	✓				
9	I felt very confident using the system.			✓		
10	I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system.			✓		

Source: Brooke, J. (1996). SUS-A quick and dirty usability scale. In P.W. Jordan, B. Thomas, I.L. McClelland and B. Weerdmeester (Eds.) Usability evaluation in industry, pp.189-194. London: Taylor and Francis.

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Designed by the authors of 'Design. Think. Make. Break. Repeat. A Handbook of Methods' (BIS Publishers)
designthinkmakebreakrepeat.com

Please assess the product now by ticking one circle per line.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7		
annoying	○	○	○	○	○	○	✓	enjoyable	1
not understandable	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	understandable	2
creative	✓	○	○	○	○	○	○	dull	3
easy to learn	✓	○	○	○	○	○	○	difficult to learn	4
valuable	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	inferior	5
boring	○	○	○	○	○	✓	○	exciting	6
not interesting	○	○	○	○	○	○	✓	interesting	7
unpredictable	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	predictable	8
fast	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	slow	9
inventive	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	conventional	10
obstructive	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	supportive	11
good	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	bad	12
complicated	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	easy	13
unlikable	○	○	○	○	○	○	✓	pleasing	14
usual	○	○	○	○	○	✓	○	leading edge	15
unpleasant	○	○	○	○	○	○	✓	pleasant	16
secure	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	not secure	17
motivating	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	demotivating	18
meets expectations	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	does not meet expectations	19
inefficient	○	○	○	○	○	✓	○	efficient	20
clear	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	confusing	21
impractical	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	practical	22
organized	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	cluttered	23
attractive	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	unattractive	24
friendly	✓	○	○	○	○	○	○	unfriendly	25
conservative	○	○	○	○	○	✓	○	innovative	26

Individual Testing Section

Name: Puttimeth Treetanajitt

Unikey: ptre0887

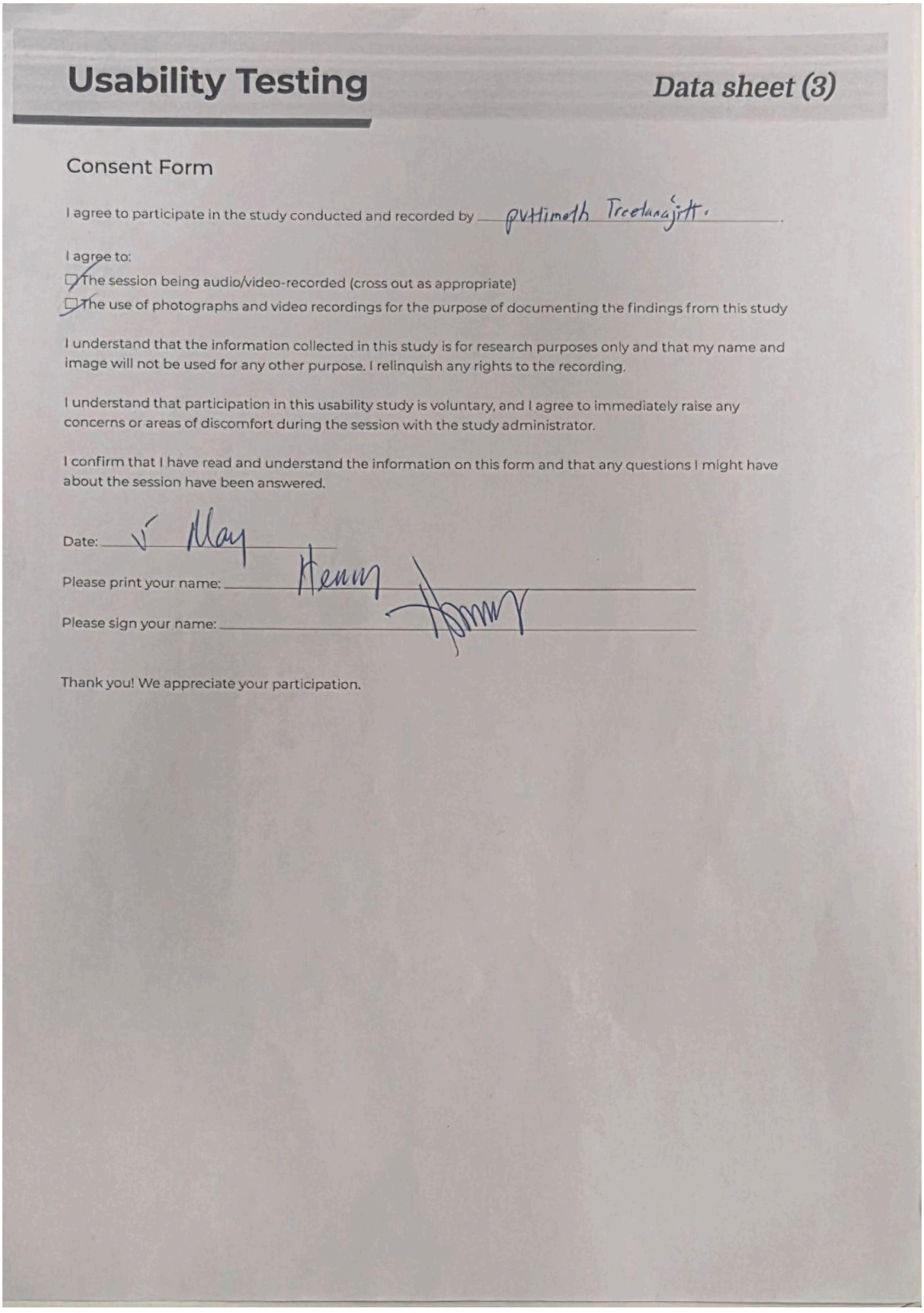
Participant Number: 3

Prototype Name: Message Drift

Participant Testing Summary:

The participant completed the testing of Message Drift with assistance and was able to do the task from leaving the message anonymously, seeing the simulation of color representing his thoughts, and enjoyed drifting the message onto the wall with a gamification mechanic. However, as soon as the half-process started, when the token came to play all the way to the end of selecting a time slot to finish the process, he felt lost interest midway and stated how the system became complex to him after the first half. As for the connection and meeting using system time slot and token help, while it depends on each person's needs, as some might want to connect with others, and some don’t want to create a consequence of their action after doing the process, which could feel forced. He suggested that it would be better to focus on the drifting message anonymously, visuals of color, and gamification, as that should be enough to connect with others through interaction and communal activity.

Consent Form:



Usability Testing

Data sheet (3)

Consent Form

I agree to participate in the study conducted and recorded by Puttimath Treetanajitt.

I agree to:

☑ The session being audio/video-recorded (cross out as appropriate)

☑ The use of photographs and video recordings for the purpose of documenting the findings from this study

I understand that the information collected in this study is for research purposes only and that my name and image will not be used for any other purpose. I relinquish any rights to the recording.

I understand that participation in this usability study is voluntary, and I agree to immediately raise any concerns or areas of discomfort during the session with the study administrator.

I confirm that I have read and understand the information on this form and that any questions I might have about the session have been answered.

Date: 1 May

Please print your name: Kenn

Please sign your name: Kenn

Thank you! We appreciate your participation.

Task completion sheet

Usability Testing

Data sheet (1)

Notetaker: Puttimeth Treetanajitt

Participant #: 3

Tested product *(e.g. website URL)*: Message Drift

Task(s) (Enter a brief description for each task)	Success (0 = Not completed, 1 = Completed with difficulty or help, 2 = Easily completed)	Time to complete	# of Errors	Notes/Observations (Note why the user was successful or not successful, e.g. wrong pathways, confusing page layout, navigation issues, terminology)
#1: Leave an anonymous message	1	1 min	1	The participant first confused ~~that~~ about system on where to press but clearly understand the point of leaving message and mood representation.
#2: Drift message to the screen interactive	1	15 sec ~~45 sec~~	0	The participation clearly understand and easily be able to flicked the message in.
#3: Use of Token	1	5 sec	1	The participant understand the tapping part but don't know that they can keep it with them
#4: Connect with anothe bottle	1	1-2 min	0	The participation understand the reason behind bottle matchs and connection.
#5: Send notify and choose time slot.	1	1 min	1	The participation understand the time slot and meetup but feel uncomfortable to connect with other people.

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Observation Notes / Observation Summary

Usability Test Observation Coding Form

Date: 5/3/26 Participant ID: P3 Task #: 1-6

Start Time: 00:53 End Time: 03:50

Verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☑ ☐ Strongly positive comment	~~For~~ ~~the~~ The gamification part help connect to other people easily. However, the participant stated that the concept is good but the process of doing it is a bit complexed and made him lost interest halfway through. The participant feel ~~they~~ he need to understand a lot to use system.
☐ ☐ ☐ Other positive comment	
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly negative comment	
☐ ☑ ☐ Other negative comment	
☐ ☑ ☐ Suggestion for improvement	
☐ ☐ ☐ Question	
☐ ☐ ☐ Variation from expectation	
☐ ☐ ☐ Stated confusion	The easiest part to understand is gamification, color representation and leaving message. The time slot part feel forced ~~s~~ to some people.
☐ ☑ ☐ Stated frustration	
Other:	

Non-verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Frowning/Grimacing/Unhappy	This participant surprised and enjoy the first half of the testing during gamification part and color showing. However he need to lean ~~to~~ closer ~~to~~ screen to see the system
☐ ☑ ☐ Smiling/Laughing/Happy	
☐ ☑ ☐ Surprised/Unexpected	
☐ ☐ ☐ Furrowed brow/Concentration	
☐ ☐ ☐ Evidence of Impatience	
☐ ☑ ☐ Leaning in close to screen	
☐ ☐ ☐ Variation from expectation	
☐ ☐ ☐ Fidgeting in chair	
☐ ☐ ☐ Random mouse movement	
☐ ☐ ☐ Groaning/Deep sigh	
☐ ☐ ☐ Rubbing head/eyes/neck	
Other:	

Task Completion Status:

Incomplete:
- ☐ Participant gave up
- ☐ Task "called" by moderator
- ☐ Thought complete, but not

Complete:
- ☐ Fully complete
- ☑ Complete with assistance
- ☐ Partial completion

Notes: Participant completed with the help of assistance and explaination but understand the first half easily

Source: https://www.uslegalforms.com/form-library/527894-usability-test-observation-coding-form

Post-test interview answers / key transcript

Q1. Do you feel that you can connect with other students better after this interaction?

Definitely, for this game, yes.

Q2. Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?

Not 100%, slightly complicated to me, the concept is nice, just the whole process is complicated with a lot of steps. I may have lost interest in the middle already, but I get your idea, but just a little bit complicated. Just a little.

Q3. What part was easiest to understand? What needs refinement?

The bottle. When I was inputting the emotion or message, and the color showed up, and the effect is so immediate that it is easy to understand, you kinda get through it immediately, rather than meeting people, and I have to wait, which I don't want to spend that much time on random people, but for the message and color bottle thing, it is pretty quite interesting.

I'm not sure about the meeting people thing. Because I'm not sure of the necessity of meeting him or her, but of course, some people may think that they are interested in connecting people. So it depends. It's quite personal, but maybe pay more attention to the first one, and after that, I got some responses from the installation, and I can start having further connections with other strangers.

Q4. Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?

Yep. It is.

Q5. Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

It still depends on the person. To me, I feel there is too much work to do, so I would rather not. I would rather have fun playing with the installation on the machine rather than have to come. I don't want to have a consequence. I just want to have immediate fun or an immediate response

Key Findings and Design Implications

Finding 1: The inputting thoughts and drifting mechanic with the representative color are very strong.
Evidence: The participant said the anonymous message is emotionally comfortable and fun to engage with.

Design implication: Keep the anonymous message and refine it.

Finding 2: Not every user wants to connect or meet.
Evidence: The participant feels uncomfortable having to wait and meet a stranger instead of just having fun, leaving thoughts, and seeing visuals.

Design implication: Improve the visibility of the choice that the user can comfortably engage with, and leave it as art, and not feel that the system is forcing them to match.

Finding 3: The system navigation needs improvement
Evidence: The participant clearly stated that they need to take time to understand the process during the explanation that, without assistance, they would not know how to proceed to the next step.

Finding 4: The token is practical but needs clear instructions
Evidence: The participant understands the need to use a token with the screen, but after the tapping process, they don't know what to do with the token after that.

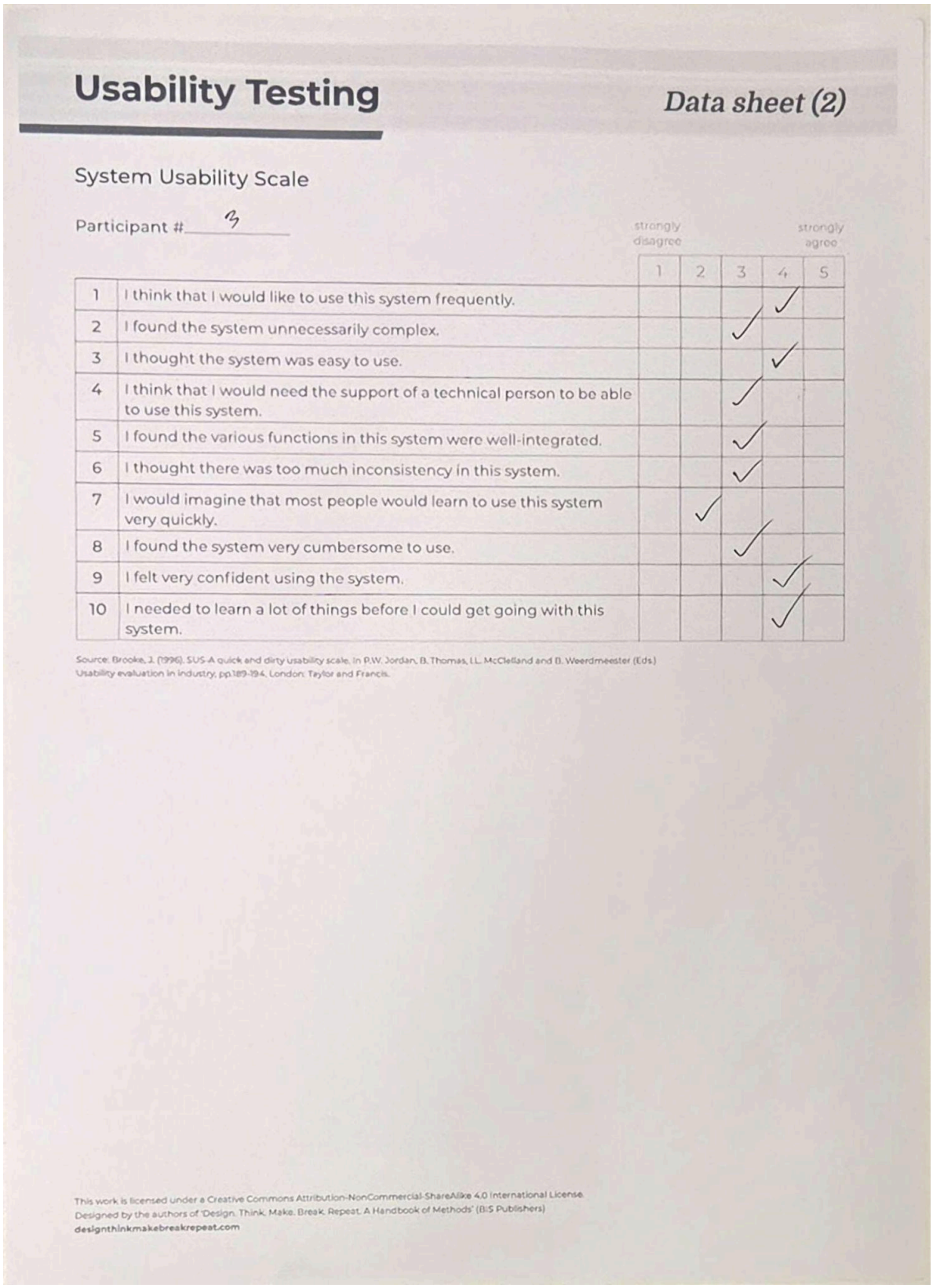
Other Group Testing Participation

Tutorial number:09
Group name: 02
Prototype name: Step by Step
My role: Participant
Date: 05/05/2026

AI Appendix

I used AI Grammarly to enhance my writing of this assignment.

Other Materials



Usability Testing

Data sheet (2)

System Usability Scale

Participant # 3

		strongly disagree 1	2	3	4	strongly agree 5
1	I think that I would like to use this system frequently.				✓	
2	I found the system unnecessarily complex.			✓		
3	I thought the system was easy to use.				✓	
4	I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.			✓		
5	I found the various functions in this system were well-integrated.			✓		
6	I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.			✓		
7	I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.		✓			
8	I found the system very cumbersome to use.			✓		
9	I felt very confident using the system.				✓	
10	I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system.				✓	

Source: Brooke, J. (1996). SUS-A quick and dirty usability scale. In P.W. Jordan, B. Thomas, I.L. McClelland and B. Weerdmeester (Eds.) Usability evaluation in industry, pp.189-194. London: Taylor and Francis.

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Please assess the product now by ticking one circle per line.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7		
annoying	○	○	○	○	○	◉	○	enjoyable	1
not understandable	○	○	○	◉	○	○	○	understandable	2
creative	○	○	○	○	◉	○	○	dull	3
easy to learn	○	○	◉	○	○	○	○	difficult to learn	4
valuable	○	◉	○	○	○	○	○	inferior	5
boring	○	○	○	○	◉	○	○	exciting	6
not interesting	○	○	○	○	○	◉	○	interesting	7
unpredictable	○	○	○	○	◉	○	○	predictable	8
fast	○	◉	○	○	○	○	○	slow	9
inventive	○	○	◉	○	○	○	○	conventional	10
obstructive	○	○	○	○	◉	○	○	supportive	11
good	○	◉	○	○	○	○	○	bad	12
complicated	○	○	○	○	○	◉	○	easy	13
unlikable	○	○	○	○	◉	○	○	pleasing	14
usual	○	○	◉	○	○	○	○	leading edge	15
unpleasant	○	○	○	○	○	◉	○	pleasant	16
secure	○	◉	○	○	○	○	○	not secure	17
motivating	○	◉	○	○	○	○	○	demotivating	18
meets expectations	○	○	◉	○	○	○	○	does not meet expectations	19
inefficient	○	○	○	○	○	◉	○	efficient	20
clear	○	○	○	◉	○	○	○	confusing	21
impractical	○	○	○	○	◉	○	○	practical	22
organized	○	◉	○	○	○	○	○	cluttered	23
attractive	○	○	◉	○	○	○	○	unattractive	24
friendly	◉	○	○	○	○	○	○	unfriendly	25
conservative	○	○	○	○	○	◉	○	innovative	26

Individual Testing Section

Name: Jingyi Ao

Unikey: jiao0884

Participant Number: 4

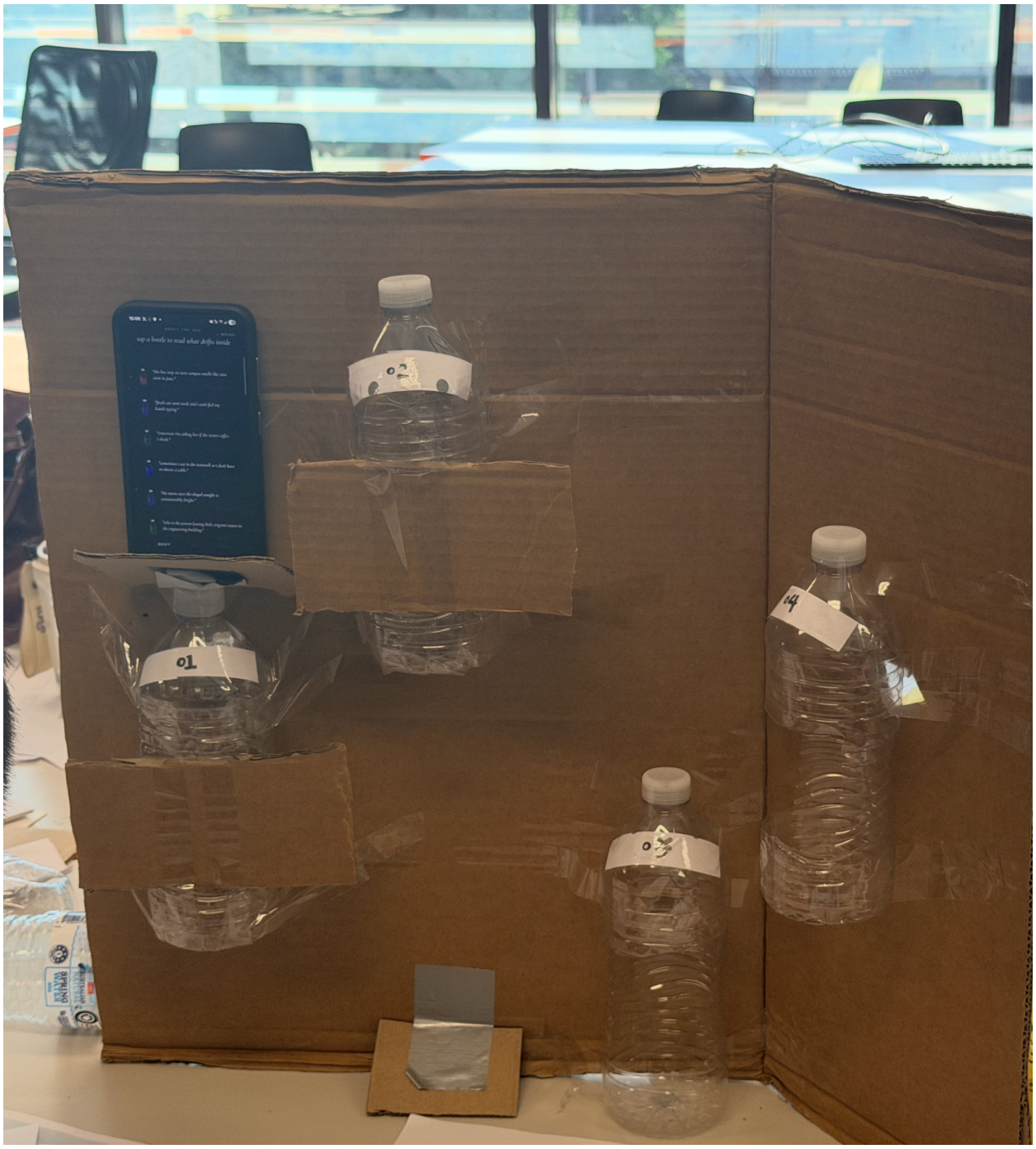
Prototype Name: Message Drift

Participant Testing Summary: The test participant completed the main interaction process, though she required some guidance from me and my team members along the way. The part she found easiest to understand was leaving an anonymous short message and sending the message in a bottle to the wall. After we explained it to her, she understood that her message would turn into a coloured bottle on the wall.

However, the subsequent steps were not entirely clear to her. She was confused about the purpose of the physical token, how her bottle would connect with another anonymous bottle, and why she needed to select a time to meet another person. She also mentioned that the entire process was ‘not very clear’, and that users might need staff assistance to explain it if they were using the system on their own.

Overall, this test demonstrated that the concepts of anonymous messages and the message-in-a-bottle wall are relatively easy to grasp, but the subsequent connection process needs to be simpler and clearer, and users must be made explicitly aware that the connection is optional.

Message Drift lo-fi prototype setup



Participant completing the Message Drift usability test



Usability Testing Data sheet

Usability Testing

Data sheet (1)

Notetaker Jingyi Ao

Participant # 1

Tested product *(e.g. website URL)*: Message Drift lo-fi prototype

Task(s) (Enter a brief description for each task)	Success 0 = Not completed 1 = Completed with difficulty or help 2 = Easily completed	Time to complete	# of Errors	Notes/Observations (Note why the user was successful or not successful, *e.g. wrong pathways, confusing page layout, navigation issues, terminology*)
#1: Leave a short anonymous message.	2	1 min	0	Participant completed this task easily after brief instruction. She typed "I'm sleep" as her message.
#2: Throw the bottle from the screen to the void.	2	1 min	0	Participant successfully sent the bottle to the void. She understand that the blue light represented her message after the facilitator explained it.
#3: Taken the bottle token and tops on the screen, keep the throughe with herself.	1	1-2 mins	1	Participant needed help understanding what the token was for and where to tap it. The token function was not immediately clear.
#4: Connect with another anonymous bottle, choose drift in closer.	1	2 mins	1	Participant asked whether the message was from someone else and where the other person was. She understand the connection after explanation, but was unsure why she needed to meet someone with a similar mood.
#5: Notify the other person and choose either a time slot or leave a message.	1	3 mins	2	participant completed this support. She was confused about the notification and time slot function, asked "choose a time for what"? and preferred leaving a message instead of arranging a meeting.

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System Usability Scale

Usability Testing

Data sheet (2)

System Usability Scale

Participant # 1

		strongly disagree 1	2	3	4	strongly agree 5
1	I think that I would like to use this system frequently.		✓			
2	I found the system unnecessarily complex.				✓	
3	I thought the system was easy to use.		✓			
4	I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.				✓	
5	I found the various functions in this system were well-integrated.			✓		
6	I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.			✓		
7	I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.		✓			
8	I found the system very cumbersome to use.			✓		
9	I felt very confident using the system.		✓			
10	I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system.				✓	

Source: Brooke, J. (1996). SUS-A quick and dirty usability scale. In P.W. Jordan, B. Thomas, I.L. McClelland and B. Weerdmeester (Eds.) Usability evaluation in industry, pp.189-194. London: Taylor and Francis.

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Consent Form

Usability Testing

Data sheet (3)

Consent Form

I agree to participate in the study conducted and recorded by Jingyi Ao.

I agree to:

☑ The session being audio/video-recorded (cross out as appropriate)

☑ The use of photographs and video recordings for the purpose of documenting the findings from this study

I understand that the information collected in this study is for research purposes only and that my name and image will not be used for any other purpose. I relinquish any rights to the recording.

I understand that participation in this usability study is voluntary, and I agree to immediately raise any concerns or areas of discomfort during the session with the study administrator.

I confirm that I have read and understand the information on this form and that any questions I might have about the session have been answered.

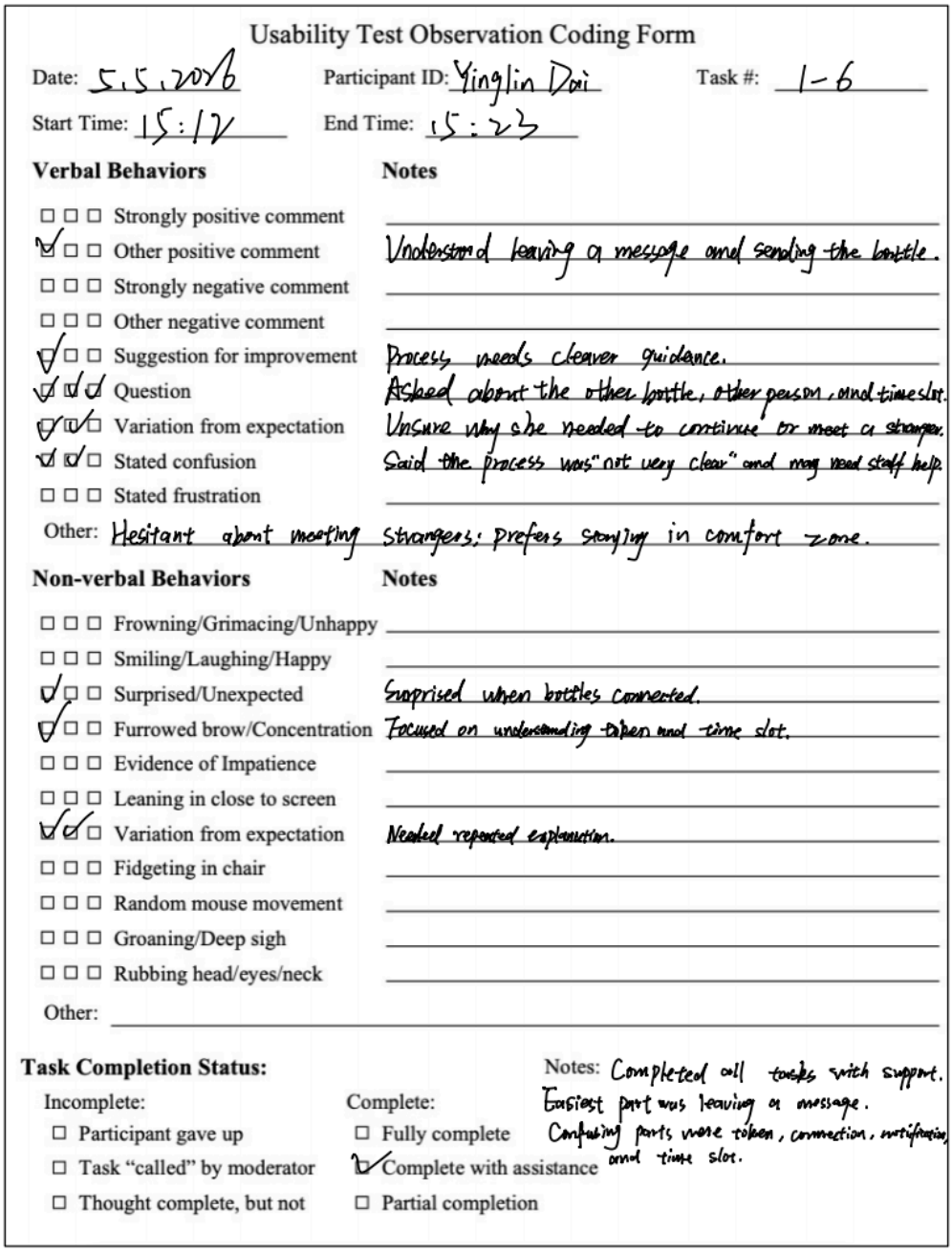
Date: 5.5.2026

Please print your name: Yinglin Dai

Please sign your name: Yinglin Dai

Thank you! We appreciate your participation.

Usability Test Observation Coding Form



Usability Test Observation Coding Form

Date: 5.5.2016 Participant ID: Yinglin Dai Task #: 1-6

Start Time: 15:17 End Time: 15:23

Verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly positive comment	
☑ ☐ ☐ Other positive comment	Understood leaving a message and sending the bottle.
☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly negative comment	
☐ ☐ ☐ Other negative comment	
☑ ☐ ☐ Suggestion for improvement	Process needs clearer guidance.
☑ ☑ ☑ Question	Asked about the other bottle, other person, and time slot.
☑ ☑ ☐ Variation from expectation	Unsure why she needed to continue or meet a stranger.
☑ ☑ ☐ Stated confusion	Said the process was "not very clear" and may need staff help.
☐ ☐ ☐ Stated frustration	
Other: Hesitant about meeting strangers; prefers staying in comfort zone.	

Non-verbal Behaviors	Notes
☐ ☐ ☐ Frowning/Grimacing/Unhappy	
☐ ☐ ☐ Smiling/Laughing/Happy	
☑ ☐ ☐ Surprised/Unexpected	Surprised when bottles connected.
☑ ☐ ☐ Furrowed brow/Concentration	Focused on understanding tokens and time slot.
☐ ☐ ☐ Evidence of Impatience	
☐ ☐ ☐ Leaning in close to screen	
☑ ☑ ☐ Variation from expectation	Needed repeated explanation.
☐ ☐ ☐ Fidgeting in chair	
☐ ☐ ☐ Random mouse movement	
☐ ☐ ☐ Groaning/Deep sigh	
☐ ☐ ☐ Rubbing head/eyes/neck	
Other:	

Task Completion Status:

Incomplete:
- ☐ Participant gave up
- ☐ Task "called" by moderator
- ☐ Thought complete, but not

Complete:
- ☐ Fully complete
- ☑ Complete with assistance
- ☐ Partial completion

Notes: Completed all tasks with support. Easiest part was leaving a message. Confusing parts were tokens, connection, notification, and time slot.

Source: https://www.uslegalforms.com/form-library/527894-usability-test-observation-coding-form

User experience questionnaire

Please assess the product now by ticking one circle per line.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7		
annoying	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	enjoyable	1
not understandable	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	understandable	2
creative	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	dull	3
easy to learn	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	difficult to learn	4
valuable	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	inferior	5
boring	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	exciting	6
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fast	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	slow	9
inventive	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	conventional	10
obstructive	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	supportive	11
good	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	bad	12
complicated	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	easy	13
unlikable	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	pleasing	14
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secure	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	not secure	17
motivating	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	demotivating	18
meets expectations	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	does not meet expectations	19
inefficient	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	efficient	20
clear	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	confusing	21
impractical	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	practical	22
organized	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	cluttered	23
attractive	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	unattractive	24
friendly	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	unfriendly	25
conservative	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	innovative	26

Post-test interview answers / key transcript

Q1. Do you feel that you can connect with other students better after this interaction?

Participant answer:
“Actually, I understand what we are doing, but it makes me a little afraid to meet someone. Because I just wrote that I’m sleepy, and maybe the other person is also sleepy. Why should I meet another person? Maybe we just go home and sleep by ourselves. Yeah, it depends.”

Q2. Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?

Participant answer:
“Actually, not very clear. Because if I want to use it, maybe I need some staff to stand here and help me figure out how to use it, how do I meet other people, or how to use this device. Oh, yeah, I need some help to understand this.”

Q3. What part was easiest to understand? What needs refinement?

Participant answer:
“The first part was easy to understand—I can leave a message and send a bottle to other people. What’s a little confusing is why I need to continue using this to keep going, like being pushed to meet someone or leave another message to talk to strangers. That’s a little confusing.”

Q4. Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?

Participant answer:
“Yeah, yeah, yeah. Actually, for me, I wouldn’t like to share my secrets or my thoughts with others. Maybe I can just share with my best friend. Yeah, so I think it depends on the person. Because if I don’t have friends, I might want to say something to find a new friend. But if I already have friends around, I just ignore it and walk away.”

Q5. Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

Participant answer:
“Yeah. I think it could help people who don’t have friends find someone with the same hobbies or interests. But for people like me, I really don’t want to join this to make new friends. I want to stay in my comfort zone.”

Key Findings and Design Implications

Finding 1: Leaving an anonymous message was the clearest part of the interaction.

Evidence: The participant said, “The first part was easy to understand — I can leave a message and send a bottle to other people.” This shows that the basic message-bottle idea was clear and easy to follow.
Design implication: Keep anonymous message leaving as the main starting point of the experience. This part should stay simple and direct.

Finding 2: The overall process still needs clearer guidance.
Evidence: The participant said the process was “not very clear” and that they might need staff to help them understand how to use the installation.
Design implication: Add clearer step-by-step instructions on the wall or screen, especially for what happens after sending a bottle.

Finding 3: Anonymous sharing may help some users, but not everyone.
Evidence: The participant said it depends on the person. They said if they did not have friends, they might use it to find a new friend, but if they already had friends, they would “ignore it and walk away.”
Design implication: The design should support different levels of participation. Some users may only want to view or leave a message, while others may want to respond or connect.

Finding 4: The optional pathway was available, but not visible enough.
Evidence: The participant felt like the system was pushing them to meet or continue talking to another person, even though the prototype included the option to stop, leave only, or not continue. This suggests that the optional choices were not noticeable enough during the interaction.
Design implication: In the next iteration, the “leave only,” “skip,” or “not now” option should be made more visible and placed next to the main “continue” button. The interface should make it clear that users can stop at any stage and still successfully participate in the artwork.

Other Group Testing Participation

Tutorial number: 10
Group name: 02
Prototype name: Healing Corner
My role: Participant
Date: 05/05/2026

AI Appendix

I used Doubao AI to transcribe the audio from my user testing video. I also used ChatGPT to help organise my testing documentation and refine some written expression for clarity. All final

content was reviewed and adapted by me based on our Message Drift prototype and my own user testing data.

Name: Zilong Zhu

Unikey: zzhu0898

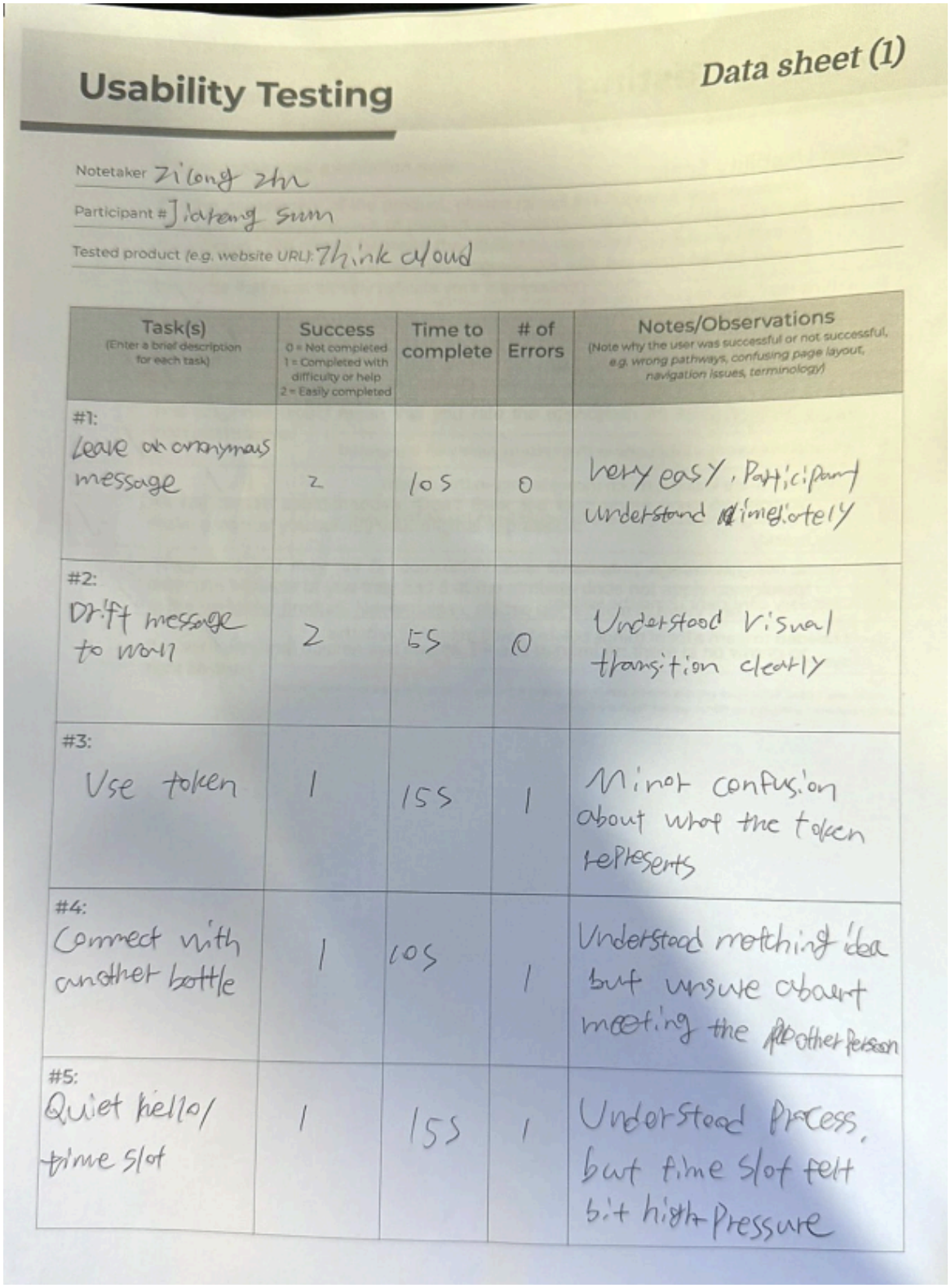
Participant Number: Jiarang Sun

Prototype Name: Message Drift

Participant Testing Summary:

The participant was able to complete most of the key tasks in the Message Drift prototype. Task 1 was completed very quickly and easily, showing that leaving an anonymous message was straightforward. The participant particularly understood and appreciated the visual drifting bottle concept. However, there was minor confusion around the purpose of the token and the later interaction steps involving meeting another person. The participant also suggested that the phone screen should have larger font and less text. Overall, the participant found the experience clear, low-pressure, and meaningful, but the time-slot feature may create unnecessary pressure and should be reconsidered in the next iteration.

Usability Testing Data sheet



Usability Testing

Data sheet (1)

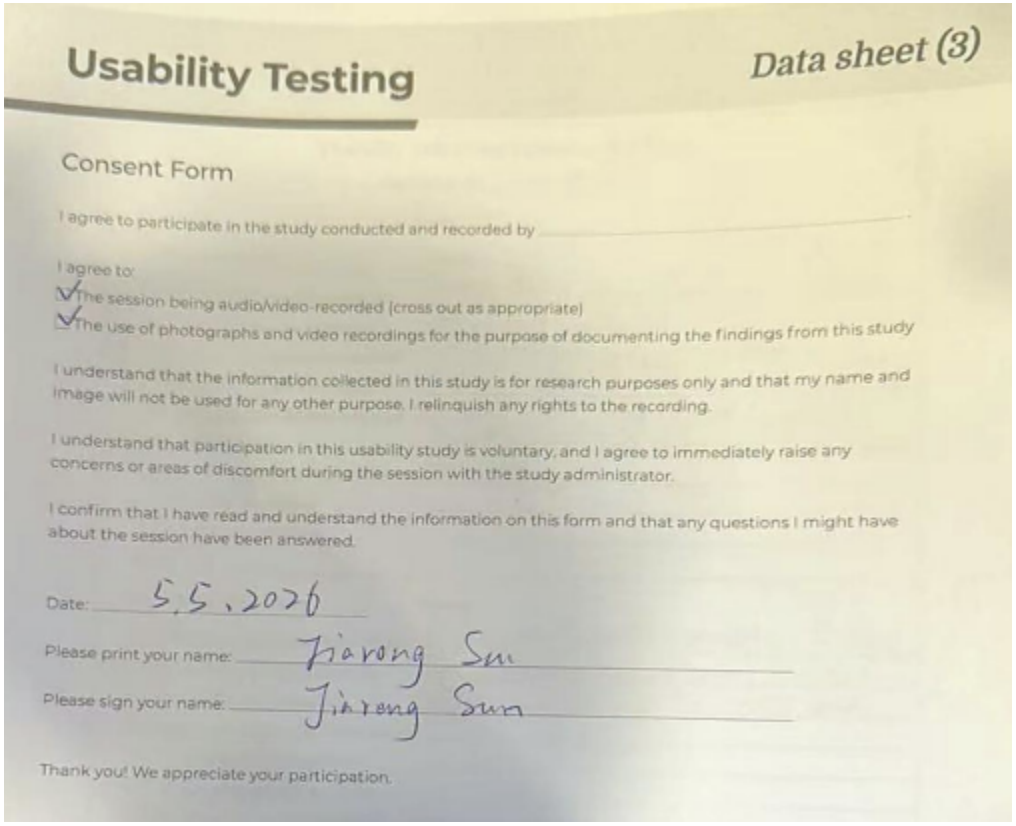
Notetaker Zilong Zhu

Participant # Jiafeng Sun

Tested product (e.g. website URL): Think aloud

Task(s) (Enter a brief description for each task)	Success (0 = Not completed, 1 = Completed with difficulty or help, 2 = Easily completed)	Time to complete	# of Errors	Notes/Observations (Note why the user was successful or not successful, e.g. wrong pathways, confusing page layout, navigation issues, terminology)
#1: Leave an anonymous message	2	10s	0	very easy, Participant understand immediately
#2: Drift message to world	2	5s	0	Understood visual transition clearly
#3: Use token	1	15s	1	Minor confusion about what the token represents
#4: Connect with another bottle	1	10s	1	Understood matching idea but unsure about meeting the other person
#5: Quiet hello/ time slot	1	15s	1	Understood process, but time slot felt bit high-pressure

Consent Form



Usability Testing

Data sheet (3)

Consent Form

I agree to participate in the study conducted and recorded by _____.

I agree to:

☑ The session being audio/video-recorded (cross out as appropriate)

☑ The use of photographs and video recordings for the purpose of documenting the findings from this study

I understand that the information collected in this study is for research purposes only and that my name and image will not be used for any other purpose. I relinquish any rights to the recording.

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I confirm that I have read and understand the information on this form and that any questions I might have about the session have been answered.

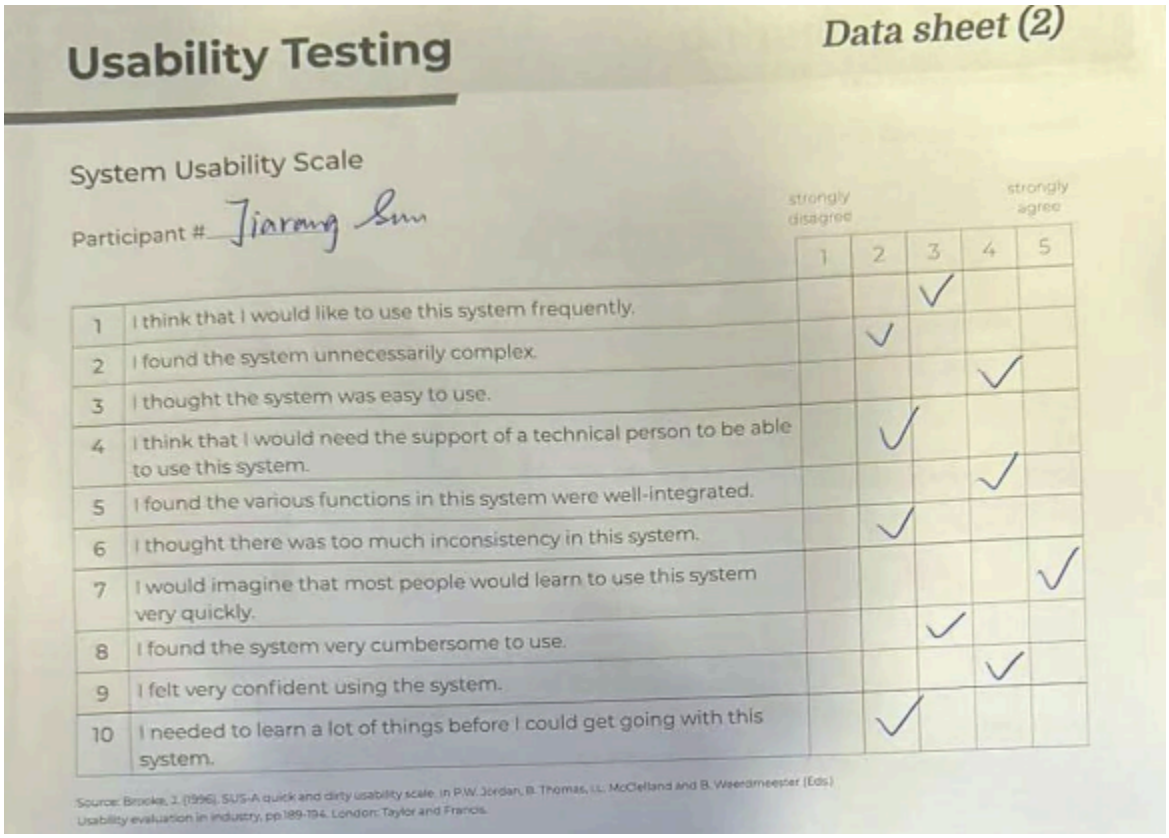
Date: 5.5.2026

Please print your name: Jiarong Sun

Please sign your name: Jiarong Sun

Thank you! We appreciate your participation.

System Usability Scale



Usability Testing

Data sheet (2)

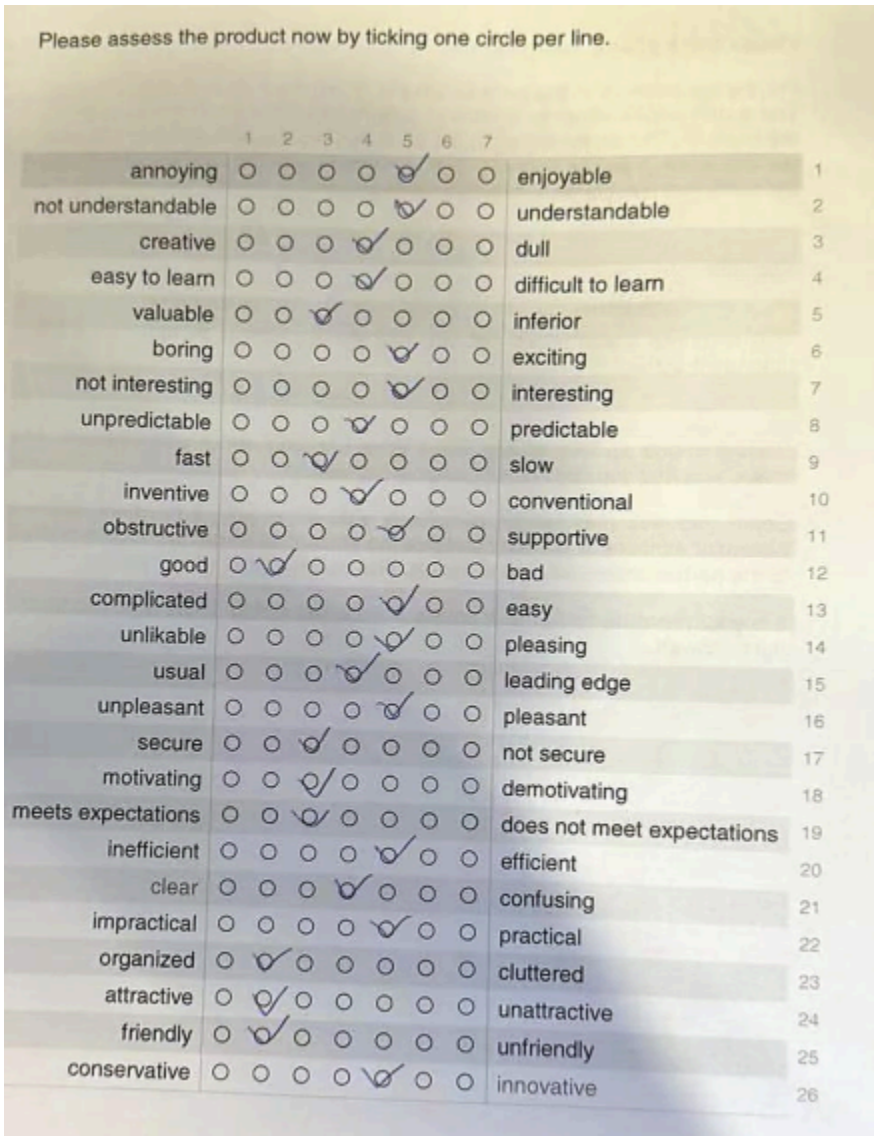
System Usability Scale

Participant # Jiarong Sun

		strongly disagree 1	2	3	4	strongly agree 5
1	I think that I would like to use this system frequently.			✓		
2	I found the system unnecessarily complex.		✓			
3	I thought the system was easy to use.				✓	
4	I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.		✓			
5	I found the various functions in this system were well-integrated.				✓	
6	I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.		✓			
7	I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.					✓
8	I found the system very cumbersome to use.			✓		
9	I felt very confident using the system.				✓	
10	I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system.		✓			

Source: Brooke, J. (1996). SUS-A quick and dirty usability scale. In P.W. Jordan, B. Thomas, I.L. McClelland and B. Weerdmeester (Eds.) Usability evaluation in industry, pp.189-194. London: Taylor and Francis.

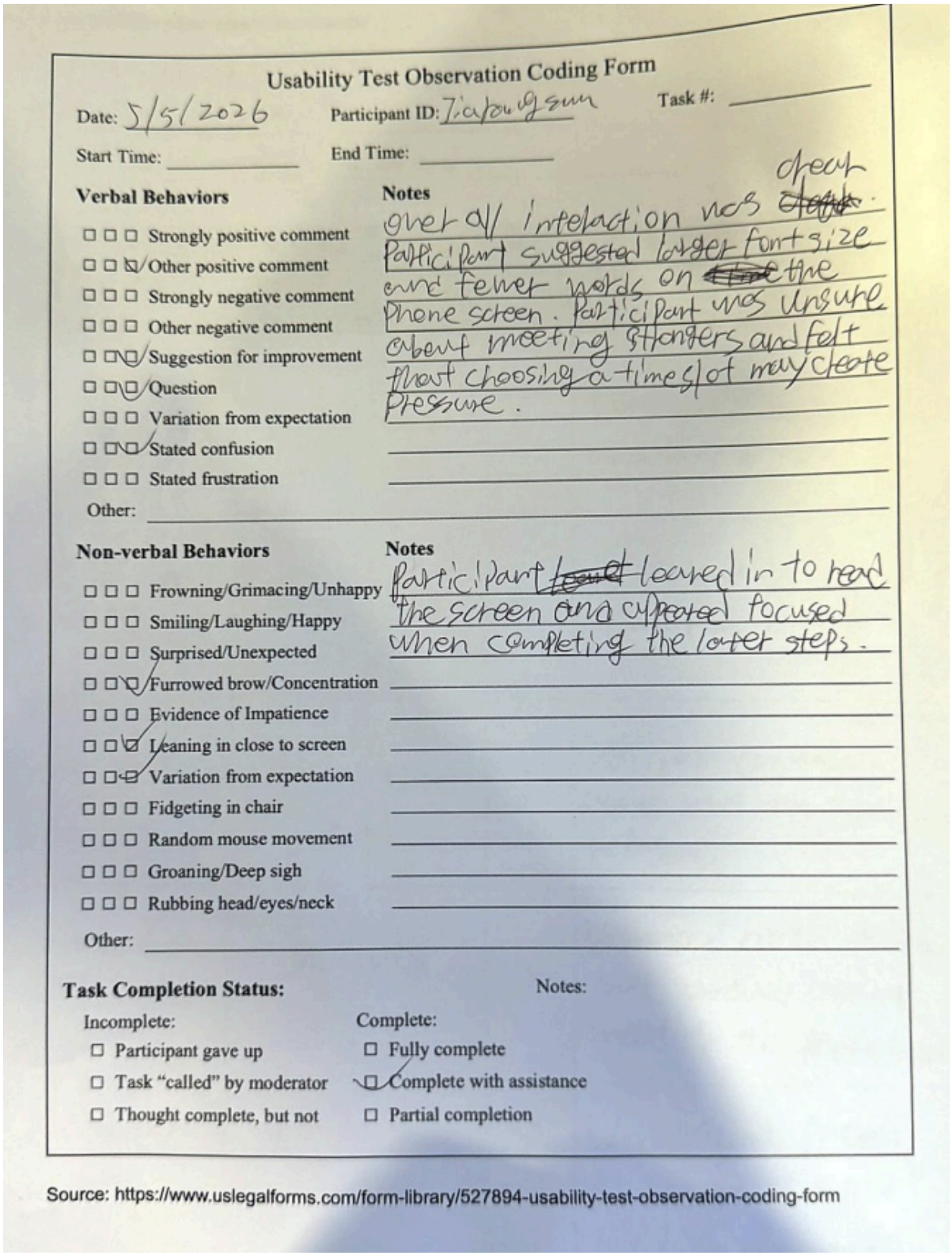
User experience questionnaire



Please assess the product now by ticking one circle per line.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7		
annoying	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	enjoyable	1
not understandable	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	understandable	2
creative	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	dull	3
easy to learn	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	difficult to learn	4
valuable	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	inferior	5
boring	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	exciting	6
not interesting	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	interesting	7
unpredictable	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	predictable	8
fast	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	slow	9
inventive	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	conventional	10
obstructive	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	supportive	11
good	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	bad	12
complicated	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	easy	13
unlikable	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	pleasing	14
usual	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	leading edge	15
unpleasant	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	pleasant	16
secure	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	not secure	17
motivating	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	demotivating	18
meets expectations	○	○	✓	○	○	○	○	does not meet expectations	19
inefficient	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	efficient	20
clear	○	○	○	✓	○	○	○	confusing	21
impractical	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	practical	22
organized	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	cluttered	23
attractive	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	unattractive	24
friendly	○	✓	○	○	○	○	○	unfriendly	25
conservative	○	○	○	○	✓	○	○	innovative	26

Usability Test Observation Coding Form



Usability Test Observation Coding Form

Date: 5/5/2026 Participant ID: Jiayuqsun Task #: _____

Start Time: _____ End Time: _____

Verbal Behaviors

- ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly positive comment
- ☐ ☐ ☑ Other positive comment
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly negative comment
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Other negative comment
- ☐ ☐ ☑ Suggestion for improvement
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Question
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Variation from expectation
- ☐ ☐ ☑ Stated confusion
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Stated frustration

Other: _____

Notes

great
over all interaction was ~~good~~.
Participant suggested larger font size and fewer words on ~~the~~ the phone screen. Participant was unsure about meeting strangers and felt that choosing a time slot may create pressure.

Non-verbal Behaviors

- ☐ ☐ ☐ Frowning/Grimacing/Unhappy
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Smiling/Laughing/Happy
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Surprised/Unexpected
- ☐ ☐ ☑ Furrowed brow/Concentration
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Evidence of Impatience
- ☐ ☐ ☑ Leaning in close to screen
- ☐ ☐ ☑ Variation from expectation
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Fidgeting in chair
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Random mouse movement
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Groaning/Deep sigh
- ☐ ☐ ☐ Rubbing head/eyes/neck

Other: _____

Notes

Participant ~~leaned~~ leaned in to read the screen and appeared focused when completing the later steps.

Task Completion Status:

Notes:

Incomplete:

- ☐ Participant gave up
- ☐ Task "called" by moderator
- ☐ Thought complete, but not

Complete:

- ☐ Fully complete
- ☑ Complete with assistance
- ☐ Partial completion

Source: https://www.uslegalforms.com/form-library/527894-usability-test-observation-coding-form

Task-based interaction transcript

Me: For this task, please throw your bottle from the screen to the wall.

Participant: Yeah.

Me: For the next task, please take the bottle token and tap it on the screen. This token keeps your thought with you, like a small personal token.

Participant: So this is my token?

Me: Yes. This is your token. It represents your bottle, so you can keep it with you.

Me: The system has now found another anonymous bottle that shares a similar thought or mood with you. Do you want to know more about them? Please choose Drift in Closer, so the system can bring both bottles closer.

Participant: So I put my token on the phone?

Me: Yes. If you do not want to continue, you can just keep the token and walk away. Your bottle can keep drifting.

Participant: Okay.

Me: Now that you are interested in meeting or connecting with the person, you can notify them by sending a quiet hello.

Participant: What happens if I do not want to meet them?

Me: You can return the token, leave the connection as part of the artwork, or choose not to continue.

Participant: So if I stay, does that mean I have to meet a different person?

Me: No, you can choose to continue, choose a time slot, leave a message, or wait. It is optional.

Post-test interview transcript

Question 1: Do you feel that you can connect with other students better after this interaction?

Participant: Probably, because this installation could help me meet someone with the same feelings or emotions. It could help random people or strangers meet in the future.

Cleaned meaning:
The participant understood the main purpose of the prototype. They thought Message Drift could help students with similar feelings connect with each other.

Question 2: Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?

Participant: Yeah, overall I think it is clear. The typing experience is a little bit unclear, and there are a lot of tips on the screen. I think you could increase the font size because larger font can make it more readable.

Cleaned meaning:
The overall interaction was understandable, but the mobile screen had too much text or small text. The participant suggested increasing the font size to improve readability.

Question 3: What part of the interaction was easiest to understand? What part needs refinement?

Participant: I think the animation of drifting the bottle and the whole visual style are cool. But personally, if this installation asks me to meet strangers, sometimes that makes me nervous.

Cleaned meaning:
The participant liked the visual style and the drifting bottle animation. However, the direct meeting function could create pressure, especially because it involves meeting strangers.

Question 4: Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?

Participant: Yeah, I think it feels low-pressure because I can see other people leaving messages. I think this is meaningful.

Cleaned meaning:
The anonymous message system helped the participant feel more comfortable. Seeing other people's messages also made the experience feel meaningful.

Question 5: Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

Participant: It may feel like too much pressure. Choosing a time to connect with another student can make the interaction feel more serious, especially when meeting a stranger.

Cleaned meaning:
The time slot feature may conflict with the low-pressure goal. It makes the interaction feel closer to a real social commitment, which may make some users nervous.

Key Findings and Design Implications

Finding 1: The anonymous message task was easy to understand.

Evidence: The participant completed Task 1 very quickly and understood that they could leave a short anonymous message.

Design implication: Keep anonymous message leaving as the main entry point of the experience. This step should stay simple, quick, and low-pressure.

Finding 2: The drifting bottle visual was successful.

Evidence: The participant liked the drifting bottle animation and the overall visual style. They understood that the bottle represented the message moving from the phone to the wall.

Design implication: Keep the drifting bottle and wall-based visual feedback as the core part of the installation. The next version should strengthen this visual interaction rather than adding too many extra steps.

Finding 3: The token needs clearer explanation.

Evidence: The participant asked whether the token was their own token and also asked whether they needed to put the token on the phone.

Design implication: Add a short explanation such as: “This token represents your bottle. Keep it if you want to receive a gentle reminder.” The token should be presented as optional, not as a required social commitment.

Finding 4: The phone screen needs better readability.

Evidence: The participant said the overall interaction was clear, but the typing experience was a little unclear. They also said there were many tips on the screen and suggested increasing the font size.

Design implication: Use larger font, fewer words, and clearer step-by-step instructions on the phone screen. Each screen should focus on one simple action.

Finding 5: The meeting and time-slot feature may create pressure.

Evidence: The participant said that meeting strangers could make them nervous, and choosing a time slot might feel like too much pressure.

Design implication: Make the connection pathway softer and more optional. Options such as “keep drifting,” “not now,” or “leave only” should be more visible. The design should avoid feeling like a dating app, matching app, or forced social platform.

Other Group Testing Participation

Tutorial number: 10
Group name: 02
Prototype name: Healing Corner
My role: Participant
Date: 05/05/2026

AI Appendix:

ChatGPT was used to help transcribe unclear interview audio and polish the wording of the user testing documentation. All content was based on our actual prototype, testing session, and collected participant feedback.

Data Analysis

Task Completion Summary

Testing Task	Overall Result	Summary of Participant Performance
Task 1: Leave an anonymous message	**Mostly completed easily**	Most participants could understand and complete the anonymous message task. They understood that they could leave a short feeling, mood, or thought through the prototype. Several participants also said this part felt low-pressure and comfortable.
Task 2: Drift the message into the sea of thoughts / wall	**Completed successfully**	Participants generally understood that their message became part of the wall as a coloured or glowing bottle. The drifting bottle visual, colour representation, and wall-based feedback were seen as engaging and easy to understand.
Task 3: Use of the token	**Completed with assistance**	This was one of the more confusing tasks. Several participants were unsure what the token was for, when to use it, whether it represented their own bottle, or whether they needed to keep or return it. This suggests the token needs clearer instructions and should be presented as optional.
Task 4: Connect with another bottle	**Partly completed, but**	Participants understood that similar bottles could be connected, but some were unsure what the connection meant. They did not know if it only showed a shared feeling, or if it meant they should meet the

	conceptually unclear	other person. This step should use softer words like “similar feeling” instead of “match”, so it feels less like a forced social connection.
Task 5: Notify the person with the token / send quiet hello	**Partly completed with confusion**	Some participants understood that the token could act as a reminder when someone responds. However, the later steps around notification, quiet hello, and continuing the connection were not always clear. Some participants were concerned that this made the experience feel more like a social app or matching system.
Task 6: Provide a time slot for connecting	**Mixed response / may create pressure**	Participants had different reactions to the time-slot feature. Some saw it as potentially helpful for people who want to meet others, but several felt it could create pressure or feel too direct, especially when connecting with strangers. This feature should be optional or replaced with a softer action.

Overall Findings and Design Implications

Finding 1: Anonymous message leaving was the clearest and strongest part of the prototype.

Evidence: Across the testing sessions, participants generally understood how to leave a short anonymous message. Several participants said this part felt easy, low-pressure, and meaningful.
Design implication: Keep anonymous message leaving as the main starting point of the experience. This step should stay simple, direct, and easy to access.

Finding 2: The drifting bottle and visual feedback were engaging and easy to understand.

Evidence: Participants responded positively to the drifting bottle, colour representation, and wall-based visual feedback. These elements helped users understand that their message became part of the public artwork.
Design implication: Keep the bottle, colour, ripple, and wall-based visual interaction as the core experience. The next version should strengthen these visual elements rather than adding too many extra social steps.

Finding 3: The token interaction was confusing and needs clearer instructions.

Evidence: Several participants were unsure what the token was for, when to use it, or whether they needed to keep or return it.
Design implication: Make the token optional and explain it more clearly as a reminder tool, not as a contact or commitment tool. Add short instructions on the screen or wall.

Finding 4: Not every user wants to connect or meet another person.

Evidence: Multiple participants liked anonymous sharing, but felt unsure or pressured when the prototype moved toward matching, meeting, or choosing a time slot.
Design implication: The design should support different levels of participation. Options such as “leave only,” “skip,” or “not now” should be more visible, so users can stop at any stage and still feel they completed the experience.

Finding 5: The overall process needs to be shorter and easier to follow.

Evidence: Participants understood the basic concept, but later steps such as token use, matching, quiet hello, and time-slot selection made the process feel more complex.
Design implication: Reduce the number of steps, use fewer words on the phone screen, increase font size, and provide clearer step-by-step guidance. The next iteration should feel more like a low-pressure public artwork, not a social matching app.

Iteration Plan for A2d

The plan is to refined iteration of the system to matched with the new insight and polish the installment while keeping the core strengths.

First, based on the insights above, the system will have simple and direct guidance on the first interaction with new users including adding a helping button on the corner of the screen if the user needs assistance. Polish the visual UI design to make it cleaner and easy to navigate without loss.

Second, while the experience of drifting bottle gamification is already strong enough with color representative and fun interaction, a minor modification could be improve in the visual such as when throw into the wall, the wall glow and the water rippled created a wave echoes to the whole wall. In short, improve the responsive effects interaction animation.

Third, after throwing a bottle into a wall and finish the process, a screen will show task completed screen with your color bottle glowing in display. Simple. Direct. Easy to understand for user.

Under the bottle is 2 buttons “done” to leave the visuals on the wall or “drift together” an option for user to be able to connect with other. If choose “drift together” the system will navigate to the next page with tutorial guide on how it work with simple 3 visuals step guide. If user change their mind they can leave at any moment where a cancel button will be provided all the time during the process.

Overall, the new iteration will be very simple and direct with few steps for user to easily follow, navigate, and finish their task. The new wireflow should follow this order:

Single interaction(One time use) Simple & Direct.
1.Interact with screen beside bottle
2.First time guide explain to user
2.Leave message or look at random message left by other(anonymously)
3.Throw bottle
4.See their bottle glowed on the wall with color
5. System ask “allowed other to find you?”. “Yes” or “No” button show [Yes=Other can match you] [No=No Match]
6.See buttons “Done” or “Connect With Other”(Continue step 7)

Connect interaction(Direct)
7. First time guide explain to user step by step with simple visual on the use of token and time slot
8. Pick up token and tap screen
9.See 2 buttons “search” or “wait”.

9.1 If tap “search” the system will look for same ideals match>show bottles matched>tap notify owner of bottle>>choose time or leave meesage>wait

9.2 If tap “wait” then finish task(Continue step 10)

10. Keep token with themselve by stick it with their phone(told in guide)

Token Owner

11. Token show light when other notified you
12. Return to the wall
13. Return token & Meet person
14. If not, tap screen with token

14.1 See message that leave behind